BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Tuesday 20 Oct 2026, 15:50 Malaysia time (07:50 UTC)

BTC ~ $81,905

Bybit 07:54 UTC | 24h -0.1% | 7d -0.3%

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, slight downside lean (range-bound under the 20-day SMA)	**Next 24h range:** $80,800 - $83,200	**Key floor:** $81,300-81,500 (50-day SMA + ETF cost basis), then $80,000	**Big event:** $12.2B monthly expiry 30 Oct; FOMC 29 Oct 02:00 MYT

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

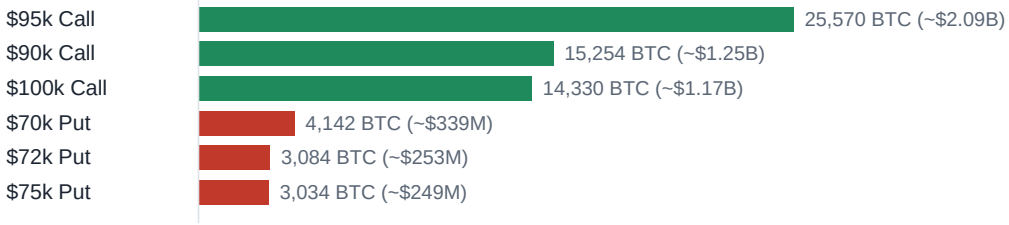
- **Today's daily expiry is at 4:00pm MYT (in ~10 minutes)**: about 3,624 BTC (~$297M). Largest single position is the **$80,000 put, 1,057 BTC** (29% of the expiry). Next daily: Wed 21 Oct 4:00pm MYT.
- Size: small. Under 1% of the ~391,000 BTC total Deribit open interest, so it should not move price on its own once settled.
- **The expiry that matters is the monthly on Fri 30 Oct** (~148,855 BTC, ~$12.2B, 38% of all OI). The weekly on Fri 23 Oct is mid-sized (~14,759 BTC, ~$1.2B as of 17 Oct).

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
Tue 20 Oct 4pm MYT	$80,000 put	1,057 BTC (~$87M)	Biggest hedge sits ~2% below spot; out of the money unless BTC drops sharply in the next minutes - will expire worthless.
Tue 20 Oct 4pm MYT	Whole expiry	3,624 BTC (~$297M)	Small; little pin effect after settlement.
Fri 23 Oct 4pm MYT (weekly)	Whole expiry (no strike breakdown published)	14,759 BTC (~$1.21B)	Moderate; can pin price near round numbers ($80k / $82k / $85k) into Friday.

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Tue 20 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	~$297M	n/a	n/a	$80k put 1,057 BTC
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.2B	n/a	n/a	Not published
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.2B	0.52	$79,000	Calls $95k 25,570 / $90k 15,254 / $100k 14,330; Puts $70k 4,142 / $72k 3,084 / $75k 3,034 BTC

Open interest by strike - 30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry (BTC; USD at $81,905)



How options affect the market now

- **Today's expiry is too small to matter.** The $80k put ends worthless at current prices; any pinning effect fades after 4pm MYT.
- **Max pain pull:** the monthly max pain is $79,000, ~$2,900 below spot. Into 30 Oct, option sellers benefit from a drift lower; this is a gentle gravity, not a target.
- **Call-heavy book (P/C 0.52):** most OI is in far out-of-the-money calls ($90k-$100k). They act as resistance only if price approaches them; for now they mostly show leftover bullish bets that are losing time value.
- **Thin put support:** put OI is small and far away ($70k-$75k), so dealer put hedging gives little cushion between $80k and $75k. A break of $80k could accelerate as stops trigger.
- **Volatility:** DVOL ~37.4 implies a ~2.0% (~$1,600) daily 1-sigma move, yet realised daily ranges are only 1.2-2.0%. Options are pricing more movement than spot is delivering - a quiet coil that usually resolves with a larger move.

- **After expiry:** with no big near-dated strike nearby, price is free to follow macro (oil, yields, ETF flows) over the next 24h.

Data note: the Deribit public API could not be reached this run, so strike-level figures are the largest seen in published reports (CryptoTicker 20 Oct and 17 Oct, Deribit data). Weekly strike detail and the weekly P/C and max pain were not published. USD sizes = BTC OI x $81,905.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC trades ~$81,905 (Bybit, 07:54 UTC), flat over 24h (-0.1%) and over 7 days (-0.3%). 24h range $81,737 - $83,035.
- Monday's push above $83,000 (with stocks rebounding) failed; Asia session sold back below $82,000 as Brent spiked to ~$111.
- Price sits between the 50-day SMA (~$81,481) and the 20-day SMA (~$83,242). Daily ranges have shrunk to 1.2-2.0% vs a 2.4% 90-day median - a tightening coil.
- October range: high $87,229 (2 Oct), low $79,709 (15 Oct). Weekly closes have held $81,400-$83,100 since 12 Oct.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,000 - $85,000	Top of the October range and 7-day high ($84,074); daily close above $84,246 opens $85,300-$86,600.
Resistance 1	$83,000 - $83,250	24h high and 20-day SMA; rejected on Monday.
Pivot	$82,000	Round number and 24h VWAP (~$82,165); side of this decides intraday tone.
Support 1	$81,300 - $81,500	50-day SMA and US spot ETF average cost basis (~$81,500, Glassnode).
Support 2	$79,700 - $80,000	Psychological level and 15 Oct monthly low; max pain $79k just below.
Deep risk	$75,000 - $76,000	50-week MA (~$76,100), Sept low $74,968 and first meaningful put OI ($75k).

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	~$52.8B (CoinGlass)	Elevated; OI rose 4.3% to ~646k BTC on 15 Oct while price fell - leverage is still in the market.
Funding rates	Turned positive (no live figure)	Mild long bias; not stretched. Live funding feed did not load this run.
Liquidations (24h to 19 Oct)	$334M all crypto; BTC ~$66M	Balanced (longs $175M / shorts $160M) - no capitulation.
Spot BTC ETF flows	+$526.6M on Mon 19 Oct	Biggest inflow since 22 Sep, all via IBIT; trims October net outflow to ~-$91M.
DVOL (30d implied vol)	~37.4	Mid-range (Oct high 39.8, 30d low 33.6); implies ~$1,600 daily move.
Fear & Greed	55 (Greed); 59 yesterday	Cooling but not fearful.

4. News and macro

- **Oil shock risk:** Brent hit ~$111 (5-month high) on attacks on Saudi infrastructure and Hormuz tanker damage, pushing BTC back under $82k this morning. Higher oil keeps US inflation and yields elevated.
- **Fed:** rates at 3.75-4.00% after the September hike; September CPI 3.7% y/y. FedWatch shows ~15-18% odds of a hike on 28 Oct and ~75-90% for December. Fed is in blackout.
- **Yields and stocks:** US 10-year near 5.1%; Nasdaq fell 4.5% last week on AI-debt worries but rebounded Monday. Netflix reports tonight; Meta and Tesla Wednesday.
- **ETF demand returns:** $526.6M net inflow on 19 Oct (IBIT only); Ether ETFs still bleeding (-$103M).
- **Strategy / MSCI:** MSCI final list due 11 Nov on excluding digital-asset-heavy firms; JPMorgan sees up to $2.8B outflow risk if Strategy (848,517 BTC) is removed.

- **Policy:** SEC comment deadline on crypto asset rules is today; White House crypto adviser Patrick Witt is leaving; CLARITY Act stalled until after 3 Nov midterms.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Tue 20 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily options expiry (~$297M)
Wed 21 Oct, ~4:00am	Netflix Q3 earnings (after US close)
Thu 22 Oct, ~4:00am	Meta, Tesla, Lam Research, TI earnings
Thu 22 Oct, 8:30pm	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly options expiry (~$1.2B)
Fri 23 Oct, 9:45pm	US flash PMIs (S&P Global)
Sun 25 Oct	Brazil presidential runoff
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am	FOMC decision (hold expected) + 2:30am press conference
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30pm	US September PCE inflation
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry (~$12.2B, max pain $79k)
Tue 3 Nov	US midterm elections
Wed 11 Nov	MSCI final list (Strategy inclusion decision)

5. Summary and prediction

BTC is coiling in a tight $81,300-$83,250 band between its 50-day and 20-day averages. Today's options expiry is small and irrelevant; the real options gravity is the $12.2B monthly on 30 Oct with max pain at $79k, which gives a mild downward pull over the next 10 days. Supportive: a strong ETF inflow day and still-neutral funding. Negative: oil above $110, 5%+ Treasury yields and thin put protection below $80k. Implied vol (~2%/day) is above what spot is delivering, hinting at a breakout soon, but with no strong signal on direction. **24h call: range $80,800-$83,200 most likely, with a slight downside lean while BTC stays below $82,000.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range	55%	$80,800 - $83,200	Oil stable around $105-111, no macro surprise; price holds 50-day SMA ($81.5k).
Bullish	20%	$83,200 - $85,000	Hourly close above $83,250 (20-day SMA), second day of strong ETF inflows, oil retreating.
Bearish	25%	$79,000 - $80,800	Hourly close below $81,300 plus oil spike above $111 or yields above 5.2%; stops below $80k could accelerate toward max pain $79k.

- **Breakout up:** 4h close above $83,250 with rising spot volume - targets $84,000-$84,250.
- **Breakdown:** 4h close below $81,300 - opens $80,000; a daily close below $79,700 would be a new October low.
- Next report: 11:50pm MYT

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